

Green & Social Claims Risk Assessment

Methodology note for client-facing website scans and uploaded internal document scans

1. Objective and scope

The tool provides a first-pass risk assessment of green and social claims in websites, claim-related documents and uploaded internal company documents. It is designed for claim governance, communications review and prioritisation of evidence requests. It is not a legal opinion, ESG rating or definitive finding of greenwashing or social washing.

Website scans review the entered domain and, where possible, a limited set of related corporate or national domains. Uploaded documents are scanned as non-public internal, investor or governance sources unless the wording is clearly consumer-facing.

2. Regulatory and standards lenses

Lens	How it is used
EmpCo / Directive (EU) 2024/825	Higher weighting for client-facing green claims: generic environmental claims, climate-neutrality and offsetting claims, sustainability labels, comparative claims and future environmental-performance claims.
EU Forced Labour Regulation / Regulation (EU) 2024/3015	Higher weighting for social claims that imply product/supplier assurance, forced-labour-free supply chains, modern-slavery controls, traceability, imports/exports, remediation or withdrawal/customs readiness.
OECD Guidelines, UNGC, UNGPs and related standards	Used as broader responsible-business expectations. These claims matter, but they generally receive lower weighting than direct EmpCo or Forced Labour Regulation risk signals.

3. Audience/channel logic

The tool distinguishes client-facing and consumer-facing communication from investor/internal sources. Consumer-facing product pages, brochures, campaign pages and marketing language are assessed more strictly under EmpCo for green claims. Annual reports, sustainability reports, ESG reports, policies, supplier codes and uploaded internal documents are treated mainly as evidence, governance and consistency sources, unless the same wording is reused in market-facing communication.

4. Score calculation

Green and social scores are calculated separately. Each dimension uses four drivers: claim wording risk (30%), substantiation gap (30%), external contradictory context (25%) and sector exposure (15%). The global score is a conservative average of the green and social scores and is capped so it cannot exceed the highest dimension score.

The model is deliberately calibrated so that sector exposure or broad wording alone should not create a High-risk result. A higher score normally requires sensitive claim wording combined with weak substantiation and/or retained external stakeholder signals. Direct EmpCo and Forced Labour Regulation risk signals can raise the relevant dimension score, but broader OECD/UNGC/UNGP-related claims are weighted less heavily.

5. External-source filtering

External public-source signals are intended to show stakeholder or third-party context. Company-owned sources are excluded from this section, including company websites, sustainability reports, annual reports, supplier codes, policies, human-rights statements, modern-slavery statements and company-hosted PDFs. These sources may still be useful as evidence or consistency context, but they are not counted as external stakeholder signals.

6. Internal-document upload

The upload function allows companies to scan non-public internal documents. Supported formats include TXT, HTML, Markdown, CSV and DOCX. PDF upload is supported on a best-effort text-extraction basis; text-based files are more reliable than scanned PDFs. Uploaded documents are assessed for claim wording, evidence gaps, audience risk and consistency with the broader methodology.

7. Sector exposure

Sector exposure is a baseline sensitivity factor. Retail, food, apparel, energy, transport, chemicals, banking and complex supply-chain sectors can be more exposed to greenwashing or social-washing allegations because of consumer claims, product impacts, financing impacts, emissions, labour conditions, human-rights risks or supplier complexity. Sector exposure is never sufficient on its own to produce a High-risk result.

8. Red flags and action recommendations

Red flags are split into green-claim red flags and social-claim red flags. Regulatory red flags are highlighted where the scan detects claim patterns that may fall directly under EmpCo or the Forced Labour Regulation lens. Recommended actions are generated from the detected claim types, such as substantiating generic green claims, clarifying climate/offset wording, verifying labels, or preparing forced-labour traceability and remediation evidence.

9. Limitations and disclaimer

The scan depends on accessible website text, search-engine results and the quality of uploaded documents. It cannot verify the truth of claims, replace legal review, or determine whether a law has been breached. The outcome is an indicative first-pass assessment for screening, governance and prioritisation. Results should be reviewed by legal, compliance, sustainability and communications specialists before being used externally.